

Claude Certified Architect – Foundations Certification Exam Guide

Introduction

The **Claude Certified Architect – Foundations** certification validates that practitioners can make informed decisions about tradeoffs when implementing real-world solutions with Claude. This exam tests foundational knowledge across Claude Code, the Claude Agent SDK, the Claude API, and Model Context Protocol (MCP) – the core technologies used to build production-grade applications with Claude.

Questions on this exam are grounded in realistic scenarios drawn from actual customer use cases, including building agentic systems for customer support, designing multi-agent research pipelines, integrating Claude Code into CI/CD workflows, building developer productivity tools, and extracting structured data from unstructured documents. Candidates must demonstrate not only conceptual knowledge but practical judgment about architecture, configuration, and tradeoffs in production deployments.

This guide describes the exam content, lists the domains and task statements tested, provides sample questions, and recommends preparation strategies. Use it alongside hands-on experience to prepare effectively.

Target Candidate Description

The ideal candidate for this certification is a **solution architect** who designs and implements production applications with Claude. This candidate has hands-on experience with:

- Building agentic applications using the **Claude Agent SDK**, including multi-agent orchestration, subagent delegation, tool integration, and lifecycle hooks
- Configuring and customizing **Claude Code** for team workflows using CLAUDE.md files, Agent Skills, MCP server integrations, and plan mode
- Designing **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** tool and resource interfaces for backend system integration
- Engineering prompts that produce reliable **structured output**, leveraging JSON schemas, few-shot examples, and extraction patterns
- Managing **context windows** effectively across long documents, multi-turn conversations, and multi-agent handoffs

- Integrating Claude into **CI/CD pipelines** for automated code review, test generation, and pull request feedback
- Making sound **escalation and reliability decisions**, including error handling, human-in-the-loop workflows, and self-evaluation patterns

The candidate typically has 6+ months of practical experience building with Claude APIs, Agent SDK, Claude Code, and MCP, understanding both the capabilities and limitations of large language models in production environments.

Exam Content

Response Types

All questions on the exam are **multiple choice** format. Each question has one correct response and three incorrect responses (distractors).

Select the single response that best completes the statement or answers the question. Distractors are response options that a candidate with incomplete knowledge or experience might choose.

Unanswered questions are scored as incorrect; there is no penalty for guessing.

Exam Results

The exam has a pass or fail designation. The exam is scored against a minimum standard established by subject matter experts.

Your results are reported as a scaled score of 100–1,000. The minimum passing score is 720. Scaled scoring models help equate scores across multiple exam forms that might have slightly different difficulty levels.

Content Outline

This exam guide includes weightings, content domains, and task statements for the exam.

The exam has the following content domains and weightings:

- **Domain 1: Agentic Architecture & Orchestration** (27% of scored content)
- **Domain 2: Tool Design & MCP Integration** (18% of scored content)